SAMVAAD 2026 · FINAL ROUND · BEFORE THE FOUNDER

ScaNxt Scientific Technologies

Own the intelligence.
Orchestrate the rest.

How a polycrisis becomes the reason ScaNxt gets more focused, not less.

TEAM KAS

Abha Nayyar 38BM01

Kishore Kunal 38BM21

Sakshi Lata 38BM46

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WHO SCANXT IS

An intelligence company that happens to make a device

ScaNxt began in 2016 as a precision-agriculture advisory platform — the device came later, as the tool that feeds the advice. Bhu-Parikshak reads soil in ~90 seconds from a 5-gram sample (N, P, K, organic carbon, clay, cation-exchange capacity) and returns a crop-specific recommendation, not just a diagnosis. Backed by an IIT-Kanpur technology transfer.

~90 sec	5 g	250/day	85-90%
per test vs ~180 min in a lab	sample vs 500 g	tests vs 25 in a lab	field accuracy, 1-yr tested

The device is really a data-acquisition machine

Every test becomes another India-specific observation in ScaNxt's database. The hardware creates the data; the data powers the advice; the advice earns the recurring revenue. Understand that loop and the whole strategy follows — this is not a device company, it is an intelligence company with a device as its sensor.

THE SCALE SO FAR

Real traction — and a base small enough to demand discipline

21+7
states + countries

650,000+
soil tests run

90,000+
farmers reached

300+
partners

Where the next push should go — pain × market size

PHASE 1 · Beachhead

Punjab · Haryana · W. UP

Highest fertiliser over-use (Punjab ~254 vs ~140 kg/ha avg) = biggest visible saving; ScaNxt's field proof already in Lucknow & Hardoi

PHASE 2 · Volume

Full UP · Andhra · Telangana

Largest markets (UP ~120 LMT) + high per-hectare use; scale the VLE network

PHASE 3 · Mission

Bihar · Maharashtra · MP

Large base, low penetration, heavy scheme activity — the subsidised model

THE DECISION THE FOUNDER FACES

Four ways to grow — a small company can fund only one well

Hardware

devices, sensors, sprayers

AI intelligence

data, advisory, prediction

Partner-led scale

govt, FPOs, entrepreneurs

Full mechanisation

EV tractors, robotics

The scarce resource isn't capital — it's management attention

Chasing all four at once stretches a still-small company across manufacturing, software, data science, financing, service and distribution simultaneously. Each layer needs a different capability base. The case's own warning: what compounds technologically can fragment organisationally.

Our decision: own the data, the device and the farmer relationship; orchestrate everything heavy through partners and government rails. Path B engine, Path A delivery — full-stack (Path C) is earned later, not assumed now.

THE PIECES ALREADY EXIST

An ecosystem in embryo — we sequence it, we don't invent it

Bhu-Parikshak

Soil test in 90 sec — the sensor & data engine

Pest Detection Station

Patented — a 2nd proprietary data stream

AgroLens

Imaging / intelligence layer

NutriNxt Conditioner

The neutral 'what to add' input

Solar Dryer

Post-harvest hardware line

Advisory app

Seasonal, regional-language guidance

Soil intelligence + pest intelligence + neutral inputs + post-harvest — under one trusted relationship

We are not asking ScaNxt to build new products. We are asking it to connect the ones it already has into a single farmer relationship — soil and pest generate the proprietary data, the advisory monetises it, the conditioner and marketplace fulfil it, the dryer deepens it beyond the season.

THE CAPABILITY MAP

What ScaNxt owns — and what it deliberately does not

OWN · the defensible spine

- ✓ India-calibrated soil & pest DATA and the models on it
- ✓ The Bhu-Parikshak device & spectral R&D
- ✓ The recommendation / decision engine
- ✓ The farmer relationship & VLE trust network
- ✓ The orchestration layer linking all four

ACCESS · rent, don't build

- → Manufacturing at scale — contract manufacturers
- → Distribution capital — FPOs, agribusiness partners
- → Device & mechanisation financing — banks / NBFCs
- → EV tractors, robotics — Custom Hiring Centres on subsidy
- → Last-mile reach — government schemes (SHC, VLSTL)

IS THE DATA ADVANTAGE REAL?

650,000 tests are a lead. The rate of capture is the moat.

The honest limit

India needs ~348 million soil tests a year; only ~2-3% are addressed. ScaNxt's 650,000 lifetime tests are ~0.2% of a single year's need.

Trace Genomics raised $48M on pure soil intelligence — and was still acquired. Data alone is not a moat.

Why it can still become one

The moat isn't the stock of tests — it's the compounding RATE of India-specific capture. At 10,000 VLEs × 800 farmers × 2 tests, that's ~16 million calibrated data points a year, per agro-climatic zone, that a foreign rival cannot buy.

A combination slow to assemble — not any single asset

Installed VLE trust network + **Years of agro-climatic calibration** + **Government embeddedness** + **Owned farmer relationship**

Protected by data-ownership clauses in every partner contract.

HOW THE MONEY WORKS

Device near-cost; earn on recurring intelligence & marketplace

One UP farmer — Ramesh, 2 acres, per year

Soil tests · 2 × ₹120	**₹240**
Advisory · ₹400 × 2 seasons	**₹800**
Marketplace inputs (no markup)	**₹0 extra**
Farmer pays	**₹1,040**

₹10,080

value created for the farmer
12% lower inputs + 8% higher yield — below the case's stated ceilings

~10-25%
value ScaNxt captures

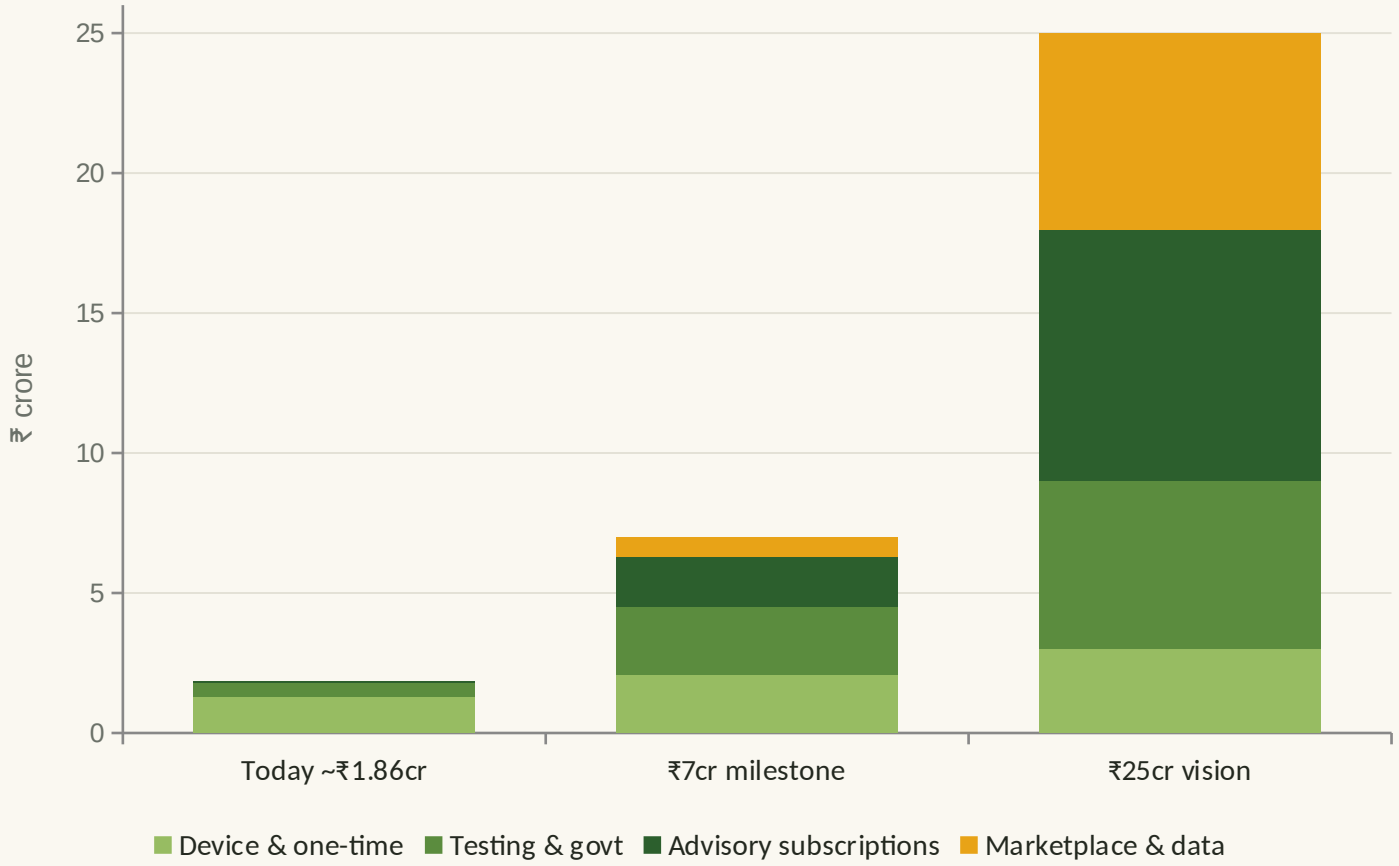
~₹1,000
ScaNxt revenue / farmer / yr

Prices anchored to real benchmarks

Test ₹100-150 (govt pays ₹190) · advisory ₹300-500/season (a fraction of the 20-30% fertiliser waste it removes) · marketplace 5-8% from the seller, never a markup on the farmer · device ₹1.17L → ~₹29k after 75% VLSTL subsidy, financed on EMI. We capture a minority of a visible gain — which is why farmers stay and never feel squeezed.

THE THREE-YEAR BRIDGE

₹1.86 cr → ₹7 cr → ₹25 cr — the engine changes, not just volume



The shift that matters

From episodic device & test revenue today, toward recurring advisory + marketplace by ₹25 cr — the mix shift the case asks for.

The credibility check

- ₹7 cr ≈ 70,000 monetised farmers
- ₹25 cr ≈ 250,000 farmers
- vs a 10-million-farmer ambition

→ ~2.5% — a credible slice

DISTRIBUTION — THE AMUL LESSON

Three tiers, built for trust: own the data, rent the reach

APEX · ScaNxt owns

Data spine · AI models · brand · partner contracts · quality standards

HUB · tier-2/3 towns (partner-run)

VLE training · device servicing & spares · input warehousing · FPO office · ~₹2L setup (Amul benchmark)

LAST MILE · Village Level Entrepreneurs

Bhu-Parikshak, serves 10-15 villages / ~800 farmers · device ~75% state-subsidised · a year-round agri-service point

What we steal from Amul: farmers trust a local face + see value immediately. **What we fix:** milk is daily, soil is seasonal — so the VLE earns year-round from advisory, pest & marketplace, not just at test time.

THE POLYCRISIS — REASSESSED

Six shocks aren't six problems. They're one trap.

The brief's key word is "together." Read the shocks as a system and they form a single trap — and our strategy is the one escape.

AI + hardware commoditise

(shocks 2 + 3)

→

Defensibility must move to DATA

the only thing not commoditised

→

Cheap data needs PARTNERS

for field access

↓

...which triggers shock 5: last-mile dependence

partners threaten control of the very data that is the moat

Capital pressure (1) + Execution complexity (6) bar the easy exits

can't own the whole last mile; can't afford to go full-stack

The one escape: asset-light data ownership

Own the data and the relationship; keep the field access by contract; rent everything heavy. We didn't design a strategy and then test it against the shocks — the shocks are the reason the strategy is what it is.

EVERY SHOCK, ALREADY ANSWERED

One posture — asset-light data ownership — answers all six

Capital pressure	No hardware creation; 3 states first; ₹20L hubs; sequence revenue — testing & advisory before marketplace. Never fund four lines at once.
AI commoditisation	A gift, not a threat. No model is perfect without data — we own it. We wrap our data around the best models rather than build our own. Cheap AI raises the value of proprietary data.
Hardware commoditisation	We concede it fully. We won't win a price war with China, so we sell the device near-cost and monetise the layer commoditisation can't touch — the recommendation and the relationship.
Climate volatility	Cuts both ways: raises demand but degrades calibration. Answer: per-agro-climatic-zone recalibration + pest alerts as a live feedback loop, so models learn from each season's real weather.
Last-mile dependence	Sell the hardware, keep the data — by contract and by architecture. Device syncs to our platform; every MoU assigns us the aggregated-data rights. That clause is the price of joining.
Execution complexity	Deliberately deferred. Earn from intelligence now; fund tomorrow's hardware R&D from tomorrow's revenue; contract-manufactured, never owned. Don't overburden farmers with tech they don't yet need.

WHAT COULD BREAK THIS — AND HOW WE'D KNOW FIRST

Two shocks that could invalidate us, with watch-triggers

SHOCK A · Commoditisation invalidates the moat

If a cheap sensor + free AI reproduce our diagnosis and advice, and a funded rival (CropX) undercuts on price.

WATCH: device gross margin below plan 2 quarters · a sub-₹50k rival NIR device launches in India · device-attach on new farmers down >15% YoY
THEN: accelerate the shift to advisory + marketplace; bundle device with advisory so the relationship, not the box, is the product.

SHOCK B · Last-mile dependence severs data control

If VLEs churn, or a large FPO/partner disintermediates ScaNxt and goes direct to the farmer with the data.

WATCH: VLE 12-month churn > 20% for 2 quarters · data-flow-back below 80% of active devices syncing · a partner requests raw (not aggregate) data rights
THEN: strengthen hub support & year-round VLE income; enforce sync-to-platform; hold the line that raw-data rights stay with ScaNxt as the price of platform access.

ON YOUR EV TRACTOR

Your tractor proves our thesis — it doesn't contradict it

We know ScaNxt just signed the MoU to commercialise India's first 100% electric compact tractor. On the surface it looks like the full-stack path we caution against. Look closer — it's the opposite.

Why it's already asset-light

- ✓ ScaNxt didn't build it — took a technology transfer from CSIR-CMERI / NRDC
- ✓ Commercialised under ScaNxt's brand — that's orchestration, not owning R&D
- ✓ 90% indigenous, compact, for smallholders; V2L powers pumps — ideal for shared / rental use

Our one refinement — sequence & rails

- → Reach farmers via Custom Hiring Centres on 75-80% govt subsidy — not farmer purchase
- → Fund it from recurring intelligence revenue, never from a strained balance sheet
- → Phase 3 — earned once the data engine funds it; never let it pull attention off the moat

Help the farmer with the tractor now — through rental and subsidy — without betting the company on hardware you'd lose to commoditisation.

THE FINAL DECISION

Permission to do less, better

Can ScaNxt use a polycrisis to become more focused, more defensible and more scalable — or will trying to own the entire future of farming be the reason it loses it?

The polycrisis is not the threat. It is the forcing function. Six shocks arriving together strip away every path that was never going to work — the hardware war we'd lose to China, the AI race we'd lose to foundation models, the full-stack build we could never afford. What is left standing is the one thing that compounds: India-calibrated data and the farmer's trust.

So ScaNxt should not try to own the future of farming. It should own the part that gets more valuable as everything else gets cheaper — the intelligence — and orchestrate the rest. Hardware keeps changing; India's soil data only deepens. This isn't a pivot. It's a return to what ScaNxt began as in 2016: an intelligence company.

The polycrisis doesn't force ScaNxt to do more. It gives ScaNxt permission to do less, better. That is how it wins.